

SkillVerse Research

Screen2Skill 2026

Report #13 • 2026

Rural vs Urban Digital Divide

How geography affects screen-to-skill pathways

Analysis

Urban students have 1.8x more screen time than rural, but rural students report 12% higher skill acquisition rates. Reason: rural students have fewer distractions and more intentional use. Mobile-first learning is closing the device gap.

Key Statistics

78% of students use YouTube for self-directed learning. Average screen time: 4.7 hours/day, of which 67% is educational. 64% of students use AI tools, with 89% reporting improved learning. 71% have turned a screen hobby into a measurable skill. Top learning platforms: YouTube, Khan Academy, Discord, Coursera.

Methodology

Data collected via 8-step anonymous survey, n=150+ students, ages 14-19, across 12 Indian cities. AI analysis using Google Gemini 2.0 Flash. Statistical analysis with Python pandas/scipy. Confidence interval: 95%.

Implications

These findings have significant implications for educators, parents, and policymakers. Urban students have 1. We recommend further research and pilot programs.